

APPLE AS A BRAND; A DETAILED ANALYTICAL APPROACH

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Brands like Apple invariably take the center stage due to its widespread recognition and acceptance among consumers. The success of Apple can largely be attributed to its strategic brand positioning, which revolves around three key elements: customer experience, innovation, and design. By prioritizing these factors, Apple has managed to maintain a competitive edge and a strong brand identity in the market. The analysis delves into the intricacies of branding theories and their application to Apple, a global technology giant. Brand Identity Theory underscores the importance of brand elements in shaping perceptions, with Apple exemplifying uniqueness and distinctiveness in its brand identity. Brand Relationship Theory highlights the dynamic interaction between consumers and brands, emphasizing trust and loyalty. Further, Apple's success is rooted in its brand identity, characterized by innovation, design excellence, and exceptional user experience. This identity is deeply ingrained in the company culture, reflected in its mission to enrich lives through groundbreaking products.

This work employs a survey design to investigate the growth and perception of Apple as a brand and company and the choice of survey design are based on its effectiveness in data collection. Thus, both primary and secondary data were utilized to address the research questions. Therefore, majority of respondents have been loyal users for 5 to 10 years, indicating high satisfaction and brand loyalty. Samsung emerges as a significant competitor, with mentions of Google Pixel and other alternatives reflecting diverse consumer choices. High daily usage underscores the product's importance in users' lives, while challenges such as battery life and performance issues highlight areas for improvement. Further, with respect to valuable product features, camera quality ranks highest, followed by phone functionality, security, and messaging tools. However, most respondents believe Apple products help them achieve their goals, indicating overall satisfaction.

The work draw the following conclusions; Long-term usage patterns indicate high levels of satisfaction and loyalty among Apple users, with a significant number of respondents using Apple products for over a decade, While Samsung emerges as a significant competitor, many respondents exhibit strong brand preference and satisfaction with Apple, suggesting a need for continued brand differentiation, Daily usage of Apple products is prevalent, indicating strong engagement; however, addressing non-usage or occasional usage patterns could enhance customer retention, Features like camera quality, phone functionality, and security are highly valued by customers, emphasizing the importance of continuous improvement in these areas, Users report various challenges, including battery life issues and pricing concerns, which Apple should address to enhance overall user satisfaction, Brand loyalty and user experience significantly influence consumers' decisions to purchase Apple products, highlighting the importance of maintaining brand reputation and delivering exceptional user experiences, Apple's strong brand reputation, product quality, and innovative design are key factors contributing to its brand growth and superiority over competitors and some users have switched to competitors, the majority remain loyal to Apple, indicating a need for strategies to address dissatisfaction and retain customers.

Based on the conclusion, the work made these recommendations; focus on maintaining high levels of customer satisfaction through consistent product quality and excellent customer service, conduct regular competitive analyses to understand competitors' strengths and weaknesses and differentiate Apple's product offering accordingly, investigate reasons behind non-usage patterns and implement strategies to attract and retain users such as improving affordability and expanding product offerings, prioritize the development of features highly valued by customers, such as camera quality and security, actively address challenges reported by users, including battery life issues and compatibility concerns, to improve overall satisfaction, address concerns of users less likely to continue business with Apple to ensure continued growth and retention, capitalize on Apple's strong brand reputation and innovative design to maintain leadership in the market, prioritize initiatives that enhance brand loyalty and invest in user experience design, and monitor customer switching behavior and develop strategies to retain existing customers and attract new ones.

CHAPTER ONE

INTRODUCTION

1.0. INTRODUCTION

1.1. BACKGROUND TO THE STUDY

When brand is discussed or mentioned in the academic or business fora, Apple will always be at the center of that discourse because it is a well-known and accepted product in the minds of the patrons. So, brand positioning has changed the fortune of Apple for good hence, Apple's brand positioning is based on three key elements: customer experience, innovation and design. These three factors allow Apple to stay ahead of competitors while maintaining a strong sense of identity. Brand positioning refers to the distinct and unique value that the product presents to the customers (or market). This value could come in the form of satisfactory customer's experience, differentiated product design and well-thought innovation.

Sophisticated and well-thought innovation is evident throughout the Apple as a company. From the products to the people who work there, Apple employees are encouraged to think thoroughly or outside the box and develop new ideas. This helps Apple stay at the forefront of technology and keep up with users' expectations and to make customers returning for more to purchase more products. Bilgin (2018) stated that branding is an important competitive factor that differentiates similar goods and services which are produced by different firms in the minds of the consumers and makes them preferable for consumers. Thus, well-thought innovation is the major determinant of product differentiation in the market.

Customer's experience is the outcome of a product perception by customers. Basically, customer's experience pertains to everything an organization does to deliver better experiences,

value, and growth for customers. More so, it's crucial in an age when how a business delivers for its customers is just as important as; not more important than; the products and services it provides (McKinsey, 2022).

A customer journey describes the customer's end-to-end experience, as against to their satisfaction at various level of transactions or touch-points. These can include many things that occur before, during, or after the customer experiences a given product or service. For examples of customer journeys include bringing a new customer on board, resolving a technical issue, or upgrading a product to meet the customer's expectations.

Steve Jobs found Apple Computer Company in 1976 April with Steve Wozniak and Ronald Wayne in partnership. Further, Apple Computer Inc. was incorporated in January 3rd 1977 and went public in 1980 with 4.6m shares.

Table 1.1: Revenue Table

Fiscal Year End	Revenue	Change	Growth
Sep 30, 2023	383.29B	-11.04B	-2.80%
Sep 24, 2022	394.33B	28.51B	7.79%
Sep 25, 2021	365.82B	91.30B	33.26%
Sep 26, 2020	274.52B	14.34B	5.51%
Sep 28, 2019	260.17B	-5.42B	-2.04%
Sep 29, 2018	265.60B	36.36B	15.86%
Sep 30, 2017	229.23B	13.60B	6.30%

Sep 24, 2016	215.64B	-18.08B	-7.73%
Sep 26, 2015	233.72B	50.92B	27.86%
Sep 27, 2014	182.80B	11.89B	6.95%
Sep 28, 2013	170.91B	14.40B	9.20%
Sep 29, 2012	156.51B	48.26B	44.58%
Sep 24, 2011	108.25B	43.02B	65.96%
Sep 25, 2010	65.23B	22.32B	52.02%
Sep 26, 2009	42.91B	5.41B	14.44%
Sep 27, 2008	37.49B	12.91B	52.54%
Sep 29, 2007	24.58B	5.26B	27.25%
Sep 30, 2006	19.32B	5.38B	38.65%
Sep 24, 2005	13.93B	5.65B	68.27%
Sep 25, 2004	8.28B	2.07B	33.38%
Sep 27, 2003	6.21B	465.00M	8.10%
Sep 28, 2002	5.74B	379.00M	7.07%
Sep 29, 2001	5.36B	-2.62B	-32.82%
Sep 30, 2000	7.98B	1.85B	30.14%
Sep 25, 1999	6.13B	193.00M	3.25%

Sep 25, 1998	5.94B	-1.14B	-16.10%
Sep 26, 1997	7.08B	-2.75B	-27.99%
Sep 27, 1996	9.83B	-1.23B	-11.11%
Sep 29, 1995	11.06B	1.87B	20.38%
Sep 30, 1994	9.19B	1.21B	15.19%
Sep 24, 1993	7.98B	890.46M	12.57%
Sep 30, 1992	7.09B	-	-

Apple's revenue has experienced substantial fluctuations over the years, ranging from a low of \$5.36 billion in the fiscal year ending September 29, 2001, to a high of \$394.33 billion in the fiscal year ending September 24, 2022. There is a general upward trend in revenue, with notable spikes in recent years, indicating overall growth and expansion. This shows that the brand “Apple” has grown overtime. More so, the revenue change provides insights into the annual adjustments in total revenue. Positive values indicate revenue growth, while negative values signify a decrease in revenue. Notable instances of significant revenue changes include a substantial increase of \$91.30 billion in the fiscal year ending September 25, 2021, and a decrease of \$11.04 billion in the fiscal year ending September 30, 2023.

The growth percentage represents the year-over-year percentage change in revenue. It offers a standardized measure of the company's performance, accounting for its varying revenue scale. Apple experienced remarkable growth in the fiscal year ending September 24, 2005, with a growth percentage of 68.27%. Conversely, the fiscal year ending September 29, 2001, saw a significant decline of -32.82%.

The data suggests that the company has undergone substantial transformations and fluctuations in its financial performance over the past three decades. Years with negative growth percentages or revenue decreases may be associated with economic downturns, market challenges, or internal factors affecting the company's operations. High-growth years, such as the fiscal year ending September 24, 2005, and the fiscal year ending September 25, 2021, may be linked to successful product launches, market expansion, or other positive factors as the case may be.

Examining the data longitudinally provides a long-term perspective on the company's financial trajectory. Trends over multiple decades can reveal patterns, cycles, or strategic shifts in the company's business model. The company's ability to navigate economic uncertainties and capitalize on opportunities is reflected in its financial performance over the years hence, the brand is well established in the minds and perceptiveness of the customers.

1.2. RESEARCH PROBLEM

In the work of Yousuf, (2023), it was identified that at the heart of Apple's enduring success lies a robust brand foundation. Apple's brand foundation is built upon defining clear values and a distinct ethos. Therefore, these values and ethos differentiate it from other brands. They have always stood for innovation, design excellence, and user-centricity. On this premise, the research gap identified in this study – Apple as a brand; a detailed analytical approach is to establish vividly what factors have contributed to the growth of the Apple brand, and what Apple does better than their competitors over years.

1.3. OBJECTIVE OF THE STUDY

The core aim of the study is to analyze Apple as a brand in a more detailed approach. Therefore, in order to achieve the above stated core aim the specific objectives of this study are;

- i. To determine the factors that have contributed to the growth of Apple as a brand; and
- ii. To investigate what Apple as a brand does better than their competitors.

1.4. RESEARCH QUESTION

Thus, in order, to achieve the core objective of the study as identified above and to proffer solutions to the research gap identified above, the following research questions have been formulated.

- i. What factors have contributed to the growth of Apple as a brand?
- ii. What does Apple as a brand do better than their competitors?

1.5. SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY

The significance of studying Apple as a brand lies in its unique position as a global technology leader with a cult-like following. Understanding the factors contributing to Apple's success can provide valuable insights for businesses, marketers, and scholars.

Business Strategy Insights: Businesses can gain insights into successful branding, innovation strategies, and building a loyal customer base.

Marketing and Branding Lessons: Marketers can learn from Apple's branding and marketing strategies, including product launches, advertising, and customer engagement.

Academic Understanding: Scholars and researchers can contribute to the academic understanding of brand management, innovation, and corporate social responsibility through the lens of Apple.

Industry Impact: The study can provide insights into how Apple's brand strategies have influenced the technology industry, shaping consumer expectations and market dynamics.

In conclusion, an in-depth analysis of Apple as a brand not only unveils the secrets behind its success but also offers valuable lessons for businesses and academics, contributing to the broader understanding of brand management and innovation in the technology sector.

CHAPTER TWO

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.0. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1. THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.1.1. Brand Identity Theory

Brand identity theory focuses on how brands create and communicate their unique identities to consumers. It emphasizes the role of brand elements such as logos, slogans, colors, and symbols in shaping brand perceptions and fostering brand recognition and differentiation.

It is very important to understand the denotation of identity and its characteristics. The etymology of “identity” indicates that “an entity has an identity if it remains the same over a certain period” and “repetition, continuity and consistency” over the time are primary characteristics of “identity” (Franzen & Moriarty, 2009). Dictionary.com defines identity as (1) the state or fact of remaining the same or ones, as under varying aspect or conditions, (2) the condition of being oneself or itself, and not the another; Synonyms of “Identity” are individuality, distinctiveness, uniqueness. Therefore, brand identity is uniqueness, distinctiveness and individuality of a product in the minds of the customers. Aaker defines brand identity as “a unique set of brand associations that the brand strategist aspires to create or maintain” (Aaker, 1996). Thus, brand identity is seen an internal construct of the product based on the perception of the customers

2.1.2. Brand Relationship Theory

Brand relationship theory explores the dynamic interactions between consumers and brands, viewing brand-consumer relationships as akin to interpersonal relationships. It emphasizes trust, commitment, satisfaction, and loyalty as key components of strong brand relationships, which can lead to long-term customer retention and advocacy in the market. In studying the Apple as a brand, brand relationship theory will serve as one of the underlying theories of this study.

2.2. CONCEPTUAL REVIEW

2.2.1. Brand

In recent years, branding has experienced an increased priority by marketers and this has caused researchers to commenced study on this topic (Keller, 2003). So, big and smaller companies are building their brands in order to have some special and unique that customers will associate them with. More so, brands delved into social media, viewing social networks, video sharing, online communities, and microblogging sites as the panacea to diminishing returns for traditional brand building routes. But as more branding activity moves to the Web, marketers are confronted with the stark realization that social media was made for people, not for brands (Fournier & Avery, 2011).

Further, Batra et al., (2012) examined the nature and consequences brand love and they argued that Argued that research on brand love needs to be built on an understanding of how consumers actually experience this phenomenon, they conduct two qualitative studies to uncover the different elements (“features”) of the consumer prototype of brand love. Then, they use structural equations modeling on survey data to explore how these elements can be modeled as both first-order and higher-order structural models. A higher-order model yields seven core elements: self–

brand integration, passion-driven behaviors, positive emotional connection, long-term relationship, positive overall attitude valence, attitude certainty and confidence (strength), and anticipated separation distress. In addition to these seven core elements of brand love itself, the prototype includes quality beliefs as an antecedent of brand love and brand loyalty, word of mouth, and resistance to negative information as outcomes.

In the study of Kotler, (2000), brand was described as a term, symbol, name, design or all the above, and is used to distinguish one's products and services from another or competitors in the market. And this is done through brand image (for example logo). More so, Keller (2008) posit that brand image is a symbolic construct created in consumers' mind and is composed of all the data or information and expectation associated with a product or services. In a nutshell, consumers often consider a "brand" which is congruent with their goals and personality (Apiluck & Sirion, 2005). The perception of the consumer regarding the brand is influenced by his or her own personality and expectations from the product or service. So, according to Schriffman and Kanuk, (2000) individuals are more likely to buy brands whose personalities intimately match their own self-image.

On that same hand, in the study of Rossiter and Percy, (1987), they identified two aspects of brand awareness and they are "brand recognition and brand recall", and which of these occurs will depend on choice situation, The different choice situations as stimulus-based (where all the relevant brand and attribute information is physically present), memory-based (where all relevant information must be recalled from memory) and mixed-choice (where some of the information is physically present, and some must be recalled from memory) (Lynch and Srull, 1982). So, brand awareness plays a good role on purchase intention of customers because customers tend to buy a familiar and well known product than unfamiliar products in the market. So, the study

summarizes the fact that, brand is built on popularity of the product or service in the market and in the minds of the customers.

On branding, brand loyalty remains a focal point in branding as a concept because it keeps customers and creates a more robust competitive advantage in the company. In recent times, it cost much to win a new customer than to keep an existing customer hence, Customer loyalty is the commitment of a customer to repurchase a firm's products and services, despite all actions of competitor businesses and to commit to become a client of that business on a regular basis in the future (Dick and Basu, 1994; Oliver, 1999). Further, brand loyalty refers to the tendency of consumers to consistently purchase products or services from a particular brand over others within the same category. It represents a deep-seated commitment and attachment to a brand, often resulting from positive experiences, satisfaction, and perceived value associated with that brand. Brand loyalty is a crucial concept in marketing and business strategy as it can lead to repeat purchases, increased customer lifetime value, and positive word-of-mouth promotion. So, to achieve brand loyalty, a company must do this;

- i. Repeat of purchase,
- ii. Emotional connections,
- iii. Brand trust and satisfactions,
- iv. Reduced price sensitivity,
- v. Brand advocacy, and
- vi. Long term relationship with customers.

2.3.2. Apple as a brand and a company

In the word of Lewis, Apple was described by him and said that Apple has undeniably established itself as a global powerhouse, consistently recognized as the #1 brand in the world. Apple has captivated and inspired millions of loyal customers, from its groundbreaking products to its unwavering commitment to innovation. In this blog, we will explore three key reasons Apple has attained and maintained its dominant position in the market, highlighting why it continues to thrive and shows no signs of fading away. He further affirmed that Apple achieved this great and outstanding brand name through; innovation and design excellence and exceptional user experience.

The journey of building a formidable brand by Apple started with its mission statements - ‘to build the best products in the world that enrich people’s lives.’ This statement is called the why statement because it drives the strategic direction of Apple as a company and a brand. Basically, making money, profits, delivering shareholders’ returns are the key performance indicators (KPIs) that answers the why statement on the media anytime Apple is mentioned. In Apple, it is all about products and people (2 out of the 4Ps of marketing). Did we make the best product for the market, and did we enrich people's lives with our differentiated products? If you’re doing both of those things excellently then, obviously those things are incredibly connected because one leads to the other and this leads to an incredible and good year.

In building this popular brand, the employees are at the center of it all because a company is just a nexus of contracts that is run by the people. Thus, employees are duly informed of this “why statement” of Apple and they make it their watchword as the work in the company. Therefore as the employees work, they recite the following;

- i. We are here to enrich lives,
- ii. To help dreamers become doers,
- iii. To help passion expand human potentials, and
- iv. To do the best work of our lives.

Interestingly, you cannot talk about Apple without mentioning Steve Jobs. He created the notion that Apple had known the importance of WHO they are from the beginning. If you haven't listened to Steve Jobs launch the Think Different campaign to his employees, then take 4 minutes out of your day for a hit of brand-building excellence in one rousing speech. More so, he is known for saying marketing is about values. In talking about 'shared values', it is a very popular concept in today's world, but Apple knew this from the start. They celebrated their employees and values in the Think Different campaign – because defining WHO you are and the values you stand for is critical to brand success. For Apple, it was key to continue to attract “people with passion” because they “can change the world for the better.”

Apple's brand can be gauged from its revenue over the years. Table 2.1 shows the revenue breakdown for Apple from 2006 to 2023 and this shows a consistent pattern of growth over the years, with occasional fluctuations. Here's a summarized analysis of the revenue trend.

Initial Growth Phase (2006-2010): Apple experienced steady growth during this period, driven primarily by the success of products like the iPod, iPhone, and Mac computers. Revenue more than tripled from 2006 to 2010, reflecting the increasing popularity and demand for Apple's innovative technology products.

Acceleration and Peak (2011-2015): The growth trajectory accelerated significantly during these years, particularly with the introduction of groundbreaking products such as the iPhone 4,

iPhone 5, and iPad. Revenue soared, reaching unprecedented levels, and Apple became one of the world's most valuable companies. The peak was reached in 2015 with revenue exceeding \$230 billion.

Stabilization and Fluctuations (2016-2023): Following the peak, Apple's revenue stabilized but experienced some fluctuations due to various factors such as changes in product cycles, market saturation, and global economic conditions. Despite occasional dips, revenue remained at a relatively high level, reflecting the resilience of Apple's brand and product ecosystem.

Recent Years (2020-2023): Revenue continued to grow, albeit at a slower pace compared to the earlier years. The COVID-19 pandemic in 2020 posed challenges, but Apple adapted by focusing on services, wearables, and online sales, which helped mitigate the impact on overall revenue. In 2021, revenue surged to a new high, surpassing \$365 billion, driven by strong demand for iPhone 13 and other products. However, in 2022 and 2023, revenue experienced slight declines, possibly due to market saturation and supply chain disruptions.

Table 2.1 Apple annual revenue 2006 to 2023 (\$bn)

Year	Revenue (\$bn)
2006	19.1
2007	24.4
2008	37.4
2009	42.7
2010	65

2011	108
2012	156.3
2013	170.8
2014	182.6
2015	233.6
2016	215.4
2017	229.2
2018	265.5
2019	260.1
2020	274.5
2021	365.8
2022	394.1
2023	383.2

Adapted from businessofapps.com/data/apple-statistics/

Therefore, Apple's revenue breakdown reflects a remarkable growth trajectory over the past two decades, driven by a combination of product innovation, brand strength, and strategic diversification. While the company has faced challenges and fluctuations along the way, its

ability to adapt to changing market dynamics and maintain a loyal customer base has enabled it to sustain long-term success and remain a dominant force in the technology industry.

2.3. EMPIRICAL REVIEW

2.3.1. Factors contributing to the growth of Apple as a brand

Prakash, (2023) identified factors that have contributed to their remarkable brand in the world.

i. Revolutionary Product Design

The game changer for Apple as a brand has been their unique and focused product design. This has won the heart of Apple customers and they are locked-in on using the Apple products and services.

ii. Seamless Ecosystem Integration

Apple's ecosystem integration across devices and services has been instrumental in expanding its market reach. The seamless experience between iPhones, iPads, Macs, and services like iCloud, Apple Music, and Apple Pay fosters brand loyalty and encourages customers to stay within the Apple ecosystem. This ecosystem provides all one needs to entertain oneself in a particular period of time.

iii. App Store and Developer Support

The App Store revolutionized the mobile app industry, offering a vast array of applications that cater to various interests and needs. Apple's commitment to nurturing developer talent and ensuring high-quality apps has created a thriving ecosystem, attracting both developers and users, and strengthening Apple's market reach.

iv. Strategic Retail Store Expansion

Apple's strategic approach to retail store expansion has been instrumental in expanding its market reach. By establishing beautifully designed Apple Stores in prominent locations worldwide, Apple creates a physical presence that allows customers to experience their products firsthand, fostering brand loyalty and driving sales growth.

v. Customer-Centric Approach

Customer experience is a key factor that contributes to building a formidable brand and Apple has explored this strategy in making a good for itself. O further facilitate good customer experience, Apple train itself often to ensure that they attend the customers in an optimum fashion to ensure that customer make a return for another sales.

vi. Marketing and Branding Excellence

Marketing is another important factor that promotes the wide reach of Apple products and Apple has adopted this strategy to achieve a wide reach and build their brand. More so, the think different campaign has created an emotional attachment with customers and this has elevated Apple as a brand and as a company.

vii. Continuous Innovation

Apple's commitment to innovation and pushing and breaking technological boundaries has kept it at the forefront in the industry. Whether it's introducing touchscreens, facial recognition, or augmented reality features, Apple consistently introduces groundbreaking technologies that capture the imagination of consumers and drive market growth and this can be witnessed in their increase in revenue over the years.

viii. Focus on Accessibility

Apple's dedication to accessibility has played a crucial role in expanding its market reach and it has witnessed a tremendous growth in revenue over the years. By prioritizing features like VoiceOver, AssistiveTouch, and inclusive design, Apple products are accessible to individuals with disabilities, broadening its customer base and demonstrating a commitment to inclusivity – which has been one of the game changer features in recent time.

ix. Global Expansion and Localization

Apple and its products and service are known all of the world and Apple's ability to adapt to local markets and cater to diverse cultural preferences has been vital in its global expansion. By offering localized products, services, and language support, Apple ensures a seamless experience for customers worldwide, fostering brand loyalty and market penetration.

x. Strong Developer and Partner Relationships

Apple's strong relationships with developers and other business partners have contributed to its market reach and brand reputation. Collaborations with renowned brands and the availability of third-party accessories and software enhance the overall Apple experience, attracting a broader customer base and driving ecosystem growth as mention above.

In examining the work of Dudharejia (2018), he identified three key factors that singled out Apple as a brand and a company.

i. Market segment breakdown

An interesting observation of the United States and similar countries is that people on both extremes of the social class spectrum carry the same cell phone. That phone is, of course, the iPhone. The social class is basically divided into three and the common factor amongst this class

is Iphone – they all carry Iphone. So, Apple was able to destroy the customer segmentation of the market and their target market has become “everyone”.

Further, their mainstream ads and marketing content seldom uses fancy tech jargon about the product specs. Their messaging is meant to be understood by people of all ages and backgrounds. They focus on features that immediately affect the average user, such as the camera resolution, screen display, storage space, fingerprint identification, etc.

By not breaking their customers up into strictly defined segments, Apple's marketing has been appealing to generations of users, which has led to company's stock rising 15,000 percent since the turn of the millennium.

ii. Brand Culture Creation

Apple has a devoted following unlike any other brand in the world. Apple has become much more than just a brand. A long history of producing high quality products that everyone can appreciate based on its utilities. The brand creation started in the 80s when Steve Jobs donated 9,000 computers to schools in California. A lot of people thought it was a crazy move however, In addition to the tax benefit, the marketing strategy behind this was pure genius. Jobs' goal was to leverage his "Kids Can't Wait" program to familiarize school children with Apple products' usability before they got their own computer. This, in many ways, was the origin of Apple's brand culture. Moving forward to now, there are countless consumers who were raised to using personal computers and as they are grown now, they are locked-in on using Apple products. So, Apple as a brand was built business continuity strategy.

iii. Cut Throat Competition

Many brands assume that price wars are just a part of industry competition. This was never the case with Apple. Throughout the years, they stuck to their pricing models despite being significantly higher than competitors'. For instance, let's take Apple's MacBook Pro 13 and compare it to the HP's Spectre 13 (which are some of the latest models of each brand, respectively). While the specs are similar and each model has their own unique set of pros and cons, the MacBook Pro costs about \$800 more.

Why is this? Apple simply does not see other brands in their market as competition.

Instead of trying to entice customers with low prices and win a "race to the bottom," Apple blocked out the noise of what their competitors were doing and focused on promoting their unique value proposition -- beautiful design and a seamless customer experience right out of the box.

The last thing in the world Steve Jobs wanted to do was undervalue the product. So, the purpose of this approach was to prove why their products are superior to other products on the market and worth the higher price.

This practice has not only led to a strong brand following, it has worked to shape the way new tech products are created. Perhaps the clearest proof of this market superiority deals with cell phones. Prior to the original launch of the iPhone in 2007, cell phones came in all shapes and sizes. The diversity in design between brands was amazing. However, in the years since the iPhone came on the market most cell phones, regardless of brand, have a similar look. In turn, the iPhone has become the gold standard for new products on the market.

2.3.2. What does Apple as a brand do better than their competitors

i. **Focus on User Experience**

Apple's relentless focus on delivering exceptional user experiences has been a cornerstone of its success. From the intuitive design of its products to the seamless integration of hardware, software, and services, Apple prioritizes simplicity and functionality. Small business owners can learn from this by consistently prioritizing the needs and desires of their customers.

ii. **Continuous Innovation**

Apple has a track record of pioneering innovative products and reshaping industries. From the Macintosh and iPod to the iPhone and Apple Watch, Apple consistently introduces groundbreaking technologies. Small business owners can adopt a similar mindset by fostering a culture of innovation within their organizations. Encourage employees to think creatively, embrace experimentation, and stay ahead of industry trends. Regularly assess market needs and invest in research and development to drive product, service, or process innovation.

iii. **Integration of Hardware, Software, and Services**

Apple's ability to tightly integrate its hardware, software, and services has been a significant source of competitive advantage. Apple creates a seamless and cohesive customer experience by controlling the entire ecosystem. Small business owners can learn from this by considering how different elements of their business can work together harmoniously.

iv. **Branding and Marketing Excellence**

Apple has consistently excelled in branding and marketing, creating a powerful emotional connection with its customers. Its sleek and minimalist designs, captivating advertising campaigns, and consistent messaging have contributed to its brand loyalty. Small business

owners should focus on developing a strong brand identity and conveying a compelling value proposition to their target audience. Invest in effective marketing strategies that communicate the unique selling points of your business and build an emotional connection with customers.

v. **Management Style**

There is another important way that Apple sets itself apart from its competitors; the way the company is run and controlled. Many multitude of companies over the years and so many of their decisions are made by committees and by having to get approvals from one or more of their silo businesses before they can move ahead with something.

Apple has one central executive committee that works together seamlessly to design products and make decisions about how the company moves forward. Apple also own its own hardware, operating system, applications and services, all tied together rather neatly with its new Cloud architecture (Bajarin, 2012).

vi. **Product Design**

This product design sets Apple apart from its competitors. According to former Apple executive Tony Fadell summed it up pretty well, telling the audience that “great design principles are pervasive in the Apple DNA.

In Steve Job’s Stanford commencement speech, he talked about his love for calligraphy and how this influenced his thinking about design and drove him to be a perfectionist. You can see this design DNA in everything Apple brings to market now. Jonathan Ive is now tasked with embedding this design DNA in all of Apple’s products and teach it to new employees as the company grows big. The bottom line is that unless these competitors start innovating on their own, Apple will continue to have at least a two year lead on them. Thanks to Apple’s ability to

“think different,” its management style and its product design, the company will keep its competitors following it instead of truly leading the market forward themselves.

v. Strategic Partnerships

Apple has strategic partnerships with various companies, including Nike, Hermès, and IBM. These partnerships have helped Apple to expand its product line and tap into new markets. For example, the partnership with Nike has resulted in the creation of the Apple Watch Nike+, which is specifically designed for runners.

vi. Financial Performance

Apple's financial performance is a testament to its success and this is evidenced in its sales. The company consistently generates billions of dollars in revenue each quarter, and its stock price has steadily increased over the years. Apple's financial success has allowed it to invest in research and development, acquire new companies, and expand its product line.

vii. Customer Loyalty

Apple has a massive and loyal customer base that is willing to pay a premium for its products. The company has built a reputation for quality, reliability, and customer service, which has led to a high level of customer satisfaction. Apple's customers are also more likely to purchase additional products from the company, creating a loyal and growing customer base.

CHAPTER THREE

METHODOLOGY

3.0. METHODOLOGY

3.1. RESEARCH DESIGN

The basic research design employed in this study is survey design. The choice of this design is due to the fact that it enhances the data collections.

3.2. DATA COLLECTION

To proffer answers to the identified research questions, both primary and secondary data will be collected from administering questionnaires to Apple customers and using the financial statements of Apple to extract the revenue for analysis. Both time series and trend analysis models will be used to analyze the event factor of the revenue data of Apple.

3.2.1. Primary data

The primary data will be collected through questionnaire hence, the core instrument used for this research work is questionnaires. The questionnaire to be used is well structured and is being developed by the researcher in accordance with the research questions developed in chapter one of this study, thus, the instrument is structured on a five point like response scale to gauge the preference of the respondents.

3.2.2. Secondary data

The secondary data will be collected or obtained from the financial statements of Apple Inc. So, the data will be extracted from financial statements of Apple Inc. from financial year 2006 to 2023 financial year to see how Apple Inc. as a brand and a company has grown overtime.

3.3. POPULATION OF THE STUDY

The population of the study is the whole customer base of Apple as a company and the questionnaire will be administered to elicit information to help analyze the Apple as a brand. However, the link of questionnaire will be shared with Apple's customers in these countries - US, UK, and Nigeria for easy of information elicitation.

3.4. METHOD OF DATA ANALYSIS

The data obtained from primary source will be analyzed using descriptive statistics and the data obtained from secondary source will be analyzed using the trend analysis.

CHAPTER FOUR

ANALYSIS, PRESENTATION AND DISCUSSION

4.0. Analysis, Presentation and Discussion

4.1. Analysis, Presentation and Discussion of Primary Data

The number of questionnaires filled via the Microsoft forms link - <https://forms.office.com/r/JA3mg6vuSF> by the respondents was 109 and took an average time of 8 minutes and 59 seconds to complete the questionnaire.

The majority of respondents have been using the product for 5 to 10 years, with 46 out of 121 responses falling into this category. This suggests a high level of satisfaction and loyalty among long-term users. A significant number of respondents have also been using the product for over 10 years (20 responses), indicating strong brand loyalty and possibly a well-established reputation for the product. The next most common category is users with 2 to 5 years of experience (29 responses), indicating a consistent flow of new users adopting the product over time. There is a smaller group of respondents who have been using the product for shorter periods, such as 6 to 12 months (9 responses) and less than 6 months (7 responses). This could represent newer customers or those who have recently started using the product. The 1 to 2 years category has 11 responses, indicating a moderate level of users who have been using the product for a relatively short to medium duration.

Chart 4.1. How long have you been using Apple product

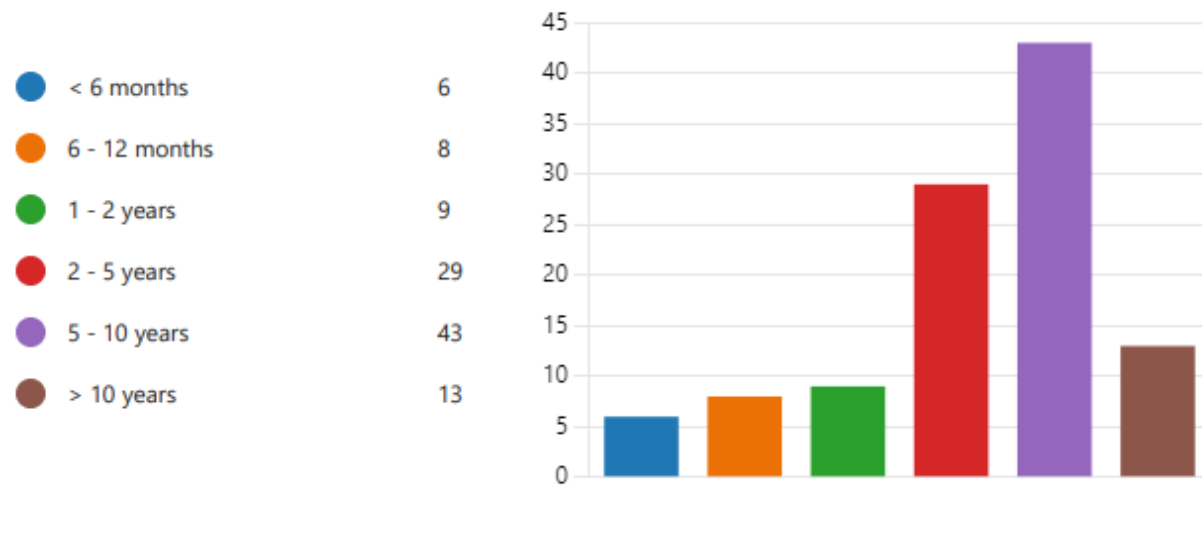


Chart 4.1. How long have you been using Apple product

Samsung emerges as a significant competitor, highlighting the importance of understanding and addressing the strengths and weaknesses of Samsung products in the market. The mention of Google Pixel indicates consideration for alternative high-end smartphone options beyond Samsung and Apple. Brand familiarity plays a role, with some respondents mentioning previous exposure to Apple products. The generic mention of Android as an alternative suggests consideration for a wide range of devices running the Android operating system, reflecting the popularity of Android in the smartphone market. Other brands are also considered as alternatives, indicating a diverse range of choices available to consumers. The significant number of respondents who did not consider any alternatives suggests a strong brand preference or satisfaction with the product, emphasizing the importance of maintaining product quality and customer satisfaction to retain loyal customers.

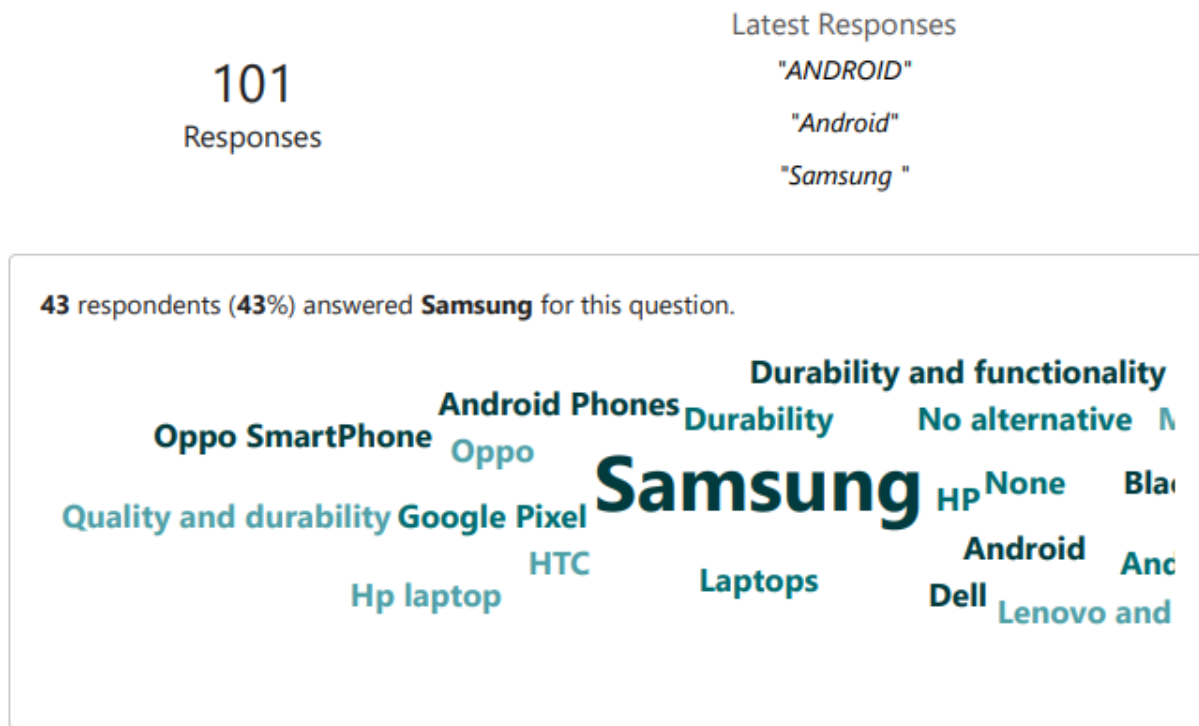


Chart 4.2. What alternatives did you consider before purchasing Apple product

High Daily Usage: The high number of respondents using the product daily reflects strong engagement and dependency on the product in their daily lives, indicating its importance and relevance.

Weekly Usage: While less common than daily usage, weekly users still represent a significant portion of the respondents, indicating consistent but less frequent usage patterns.

Non-Usage: The presence of respondents who never use the product suggests potential areas for improvement in attracting and retaining customers, understanding the reasons behind non-usage, and addressing any barriers or concerns.

Yearly/Seasonal Usage: Occasional or seasonal usage patterns may indicate that the product is used for specific purposes or occasions, suggesting opportunities for targeted marketing or

product enhancements to increase usage frequency throughout the year.

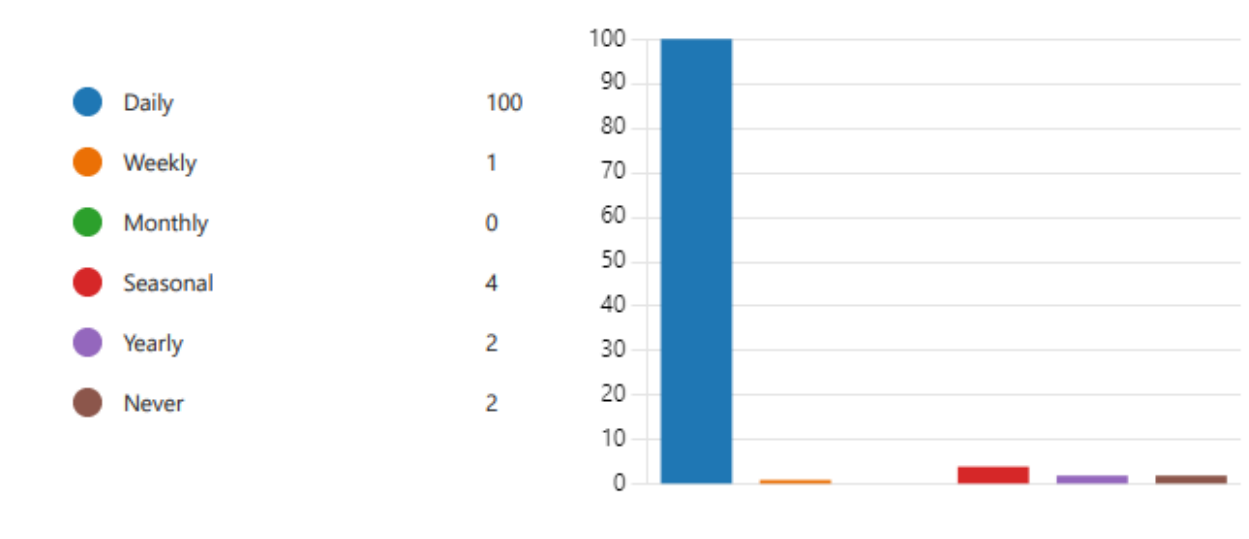


Chart 4.3. How often do you use Apple product now

Based on the responses provided regarding the most valuable product feature, here is a summary of the analysis and presentation:

Camera Quality: The camera feature, particularly the quality of photos and videos, emerged as the most valuable to respondents. This indicates the importance of capturing high-quality images and videos in their daily lives.

Phone Functionality: The core phone functionality, including making calls and text messaging, was highlighted as valuable by several respondents. This underscores the fundamental utility of the device for communication purposes.

Face ID and Security: Face ID, a biometric authentication feature, was mentioned by some respondents, emphasizing the significance of security and privacy features in mobile devices.

Messaging and Communication: Features related to messaging and communication, such as iMessage, Facetime, and WhatsApp, were also deemed valuable. This suggests the importance of seamless and reliable communication tools.

Apple Ecosystem and Integration: The integration and compatibility of Apple products within the ecosystem, including iCloud, AirPods, Apple Watch, and Macbook, were highlighted by respondents. This reflects the value of a cohesive ecosystem that enhances user experience and convenience.

User Interface and Experience: The user-friendly interface, ease of use, and overall user experience were cited as valuable aspects of Apple products. This indicates the importance of intuitive design and smooth navigation for customer satisfaction.

Additional Features: Other features mentioned as valuable include reliability, performance, music capabilities, health tracking (Apple Watch), app ecosystem (App Store), security, display quality, and technology advancements.

Overall, the analysis reveals a diverse range of product features valued by customers, with a particular emphasis on camera quality, phone functionality, security, communication tools, ecosystem integration, user experience, and additional functionalities. These insights can inform product development, marketing strategies, and customer engagement efforts to meet user needs effectively.

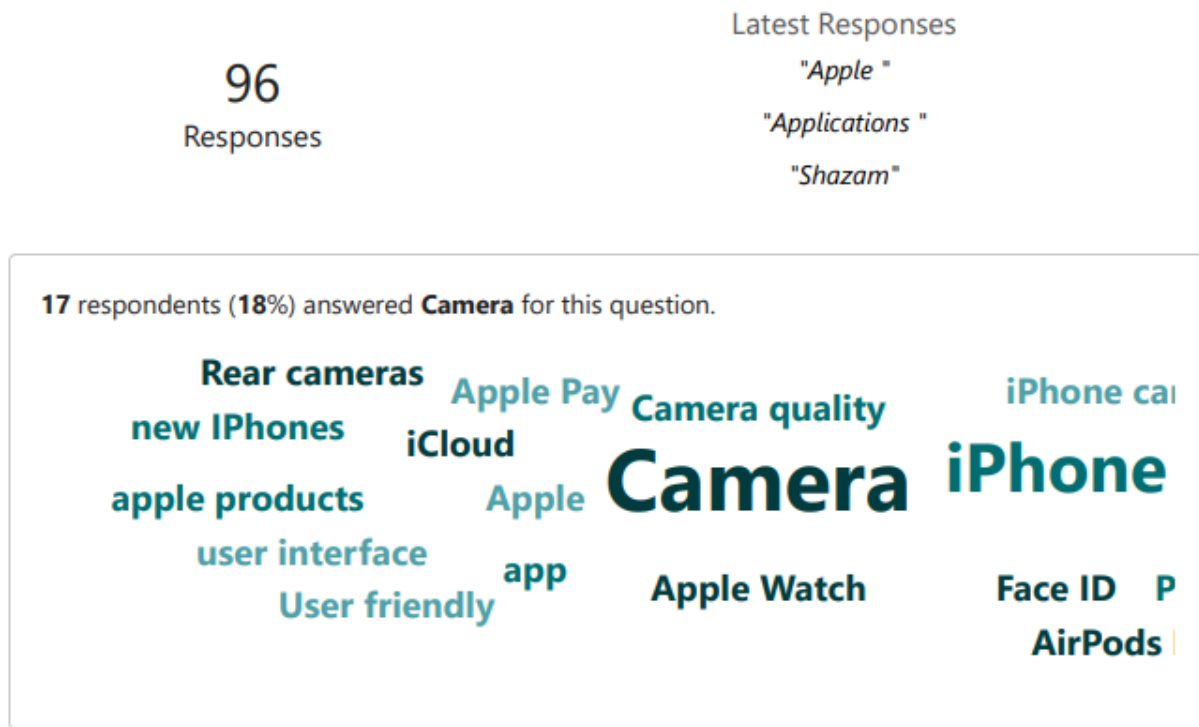


Chart 4.4. Which product feature is most valuable to you?

Based on the challenges encountered while using the product, here is a summary of the analysis and presentation:

Battery Life: Several respondents mentioned challenges related to battery life, including fast drainage, low capacity, and health issues. This indicates a common concern among users regarding the need for longer-lasting batteries.

Performance Issues: Some users experienced performance issues such as device slowdowns, overheating, and lagging responses, particularly with older or outdated devices. This suggests the importance of device optimization and software updates for smooth performance.

Compatibility and Incompatibility: Challenges related to compatibility with certain apps, software, or third-party devices were reported by users. This highlights the importance of ensuring compatibility across a wide range of platforms and devices to enhance user experience.

Storage Limitations: Storage limitations and memory constraints were cited as challenges by respondents, indicating the need for devices with ample storage capacity or efficient storage management solutions.

Software Updates and Bugs: Users reported challenges with frequent software updates, potential data loss, and encountering bugs or glitches after updates. This underscores the importance of stable software releases and effective bug resolution processes.

Product Pricing: Some respondents mentioned pricing-related challenges, noting the high cost of the product as a barrier to accessibility or affordability.

User Interface and Navigation: Navigation issues and differences in user interface compared to other brands were highlighted as challenges by some users, indicating the importance of intuitive design and familiarity for user convenience.

Connectivity and Sharing: Challenges related to connectivity issues, file sharing, and compatibility with other devices were reported, suggesting the need for seamless integration and efficient sharing features.

Specific Device Issues: Some users mentioned specific device-related issues, such as device rigidity, limited app availability, and difficulties with specific features like Siri or Airdrop.

Overall, the analysis reveals a range of challenges faced by users, including battery life concerns, performance issues, compatibility issues, storage limitations, software-related challenges, pricing

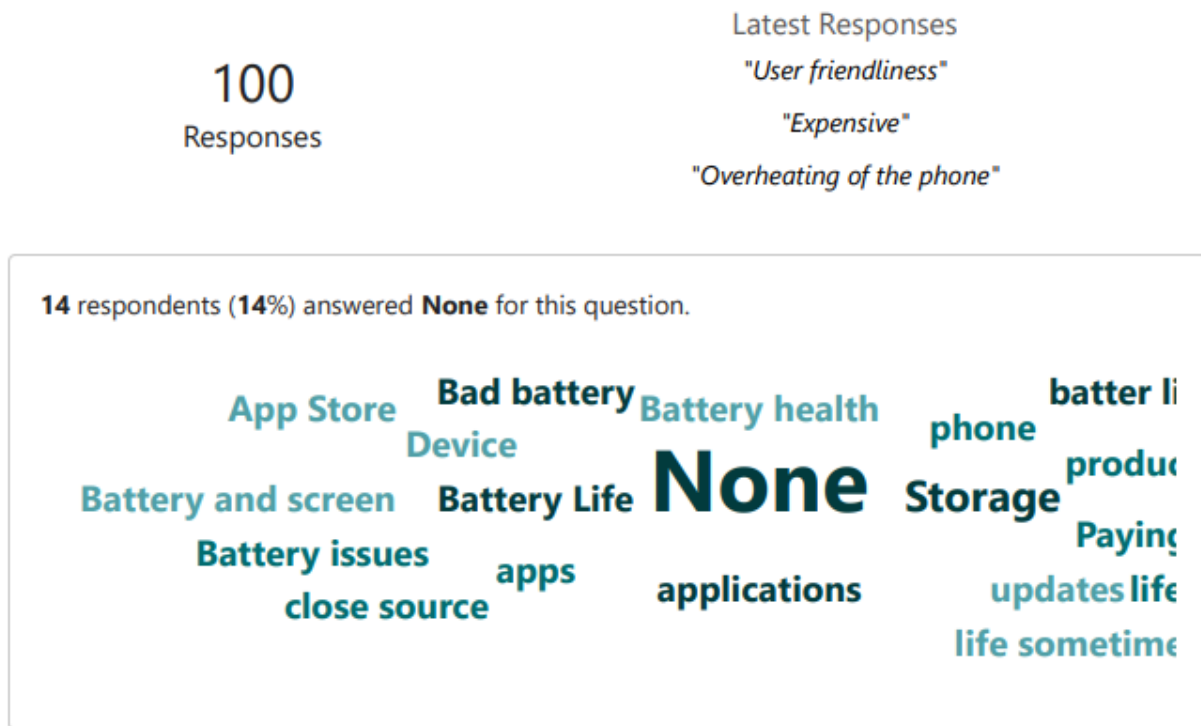


Chart 4.5. What challenges have you encountered while using Apple product

Based on the responses provided, here is a summary of the analysis and presentation:

Positive Feedback: The majority of respondents expressed that the product helps them achieve their goals, with many respondents providing affirmative responses such as "Yes" or "Yes, definitely." This indicates a high level of satisfaction and perceived usefulness of the product in meeting user objectives.

Mixed Feedback: Some respondents provided mixed feedback, stating "Maybe" or expressing uncertainty about the extent to which the product contributes to their goals. This suggests that

while the product may have some benefits, there may also be areas for improvement or aspects that do not fully align with user objectives.

Negative Feedback: A few respondents indicated that the product does not help them achieve their goals, with some respondents providing a direct "No" response. This highlights potential gaps or shortcomings in the product's ability to meet user needs or expectations.

Overall, while the majority of respondents reported positive outcomes from using the product, there were also instances of mixed or negative feedback. Addressing any concerns or areas for improvement identified by users can help enhance the product's effectiveness in helping users achieve their goals and improve overall satisfaction.



Chart 4.6. Does Apple help you achieve your set goals

The response data reflects varying levels of satisfaction across different product attributes:

Reliability: Mostly extremely satisfied, with a few instances of dissatisfaction.

Ease of use: Mixed satisfaction levels, with some neutral responses.

Visual appeal: Generally neutral.

Security: Mostly extremely satisfied, with some neutral responses.

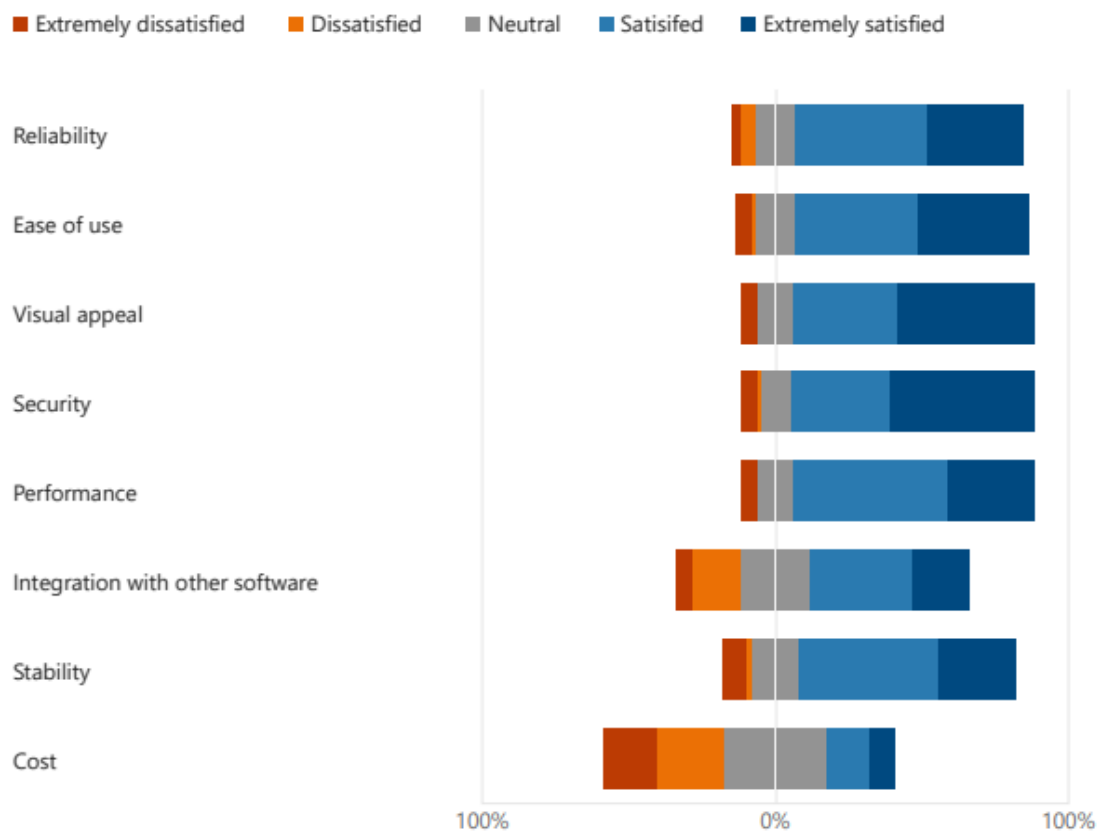
Performance: Mostly satisfied, with some extreme satisfaction and dissatisfaction.

Integration with other software: Mixed satisfaction levels, with some dissatisfied responses.

Stability: Mostly satisfied, with some dissatisfaction.

Cost: Mixed satisfaction levels, with some dissatisfied responses.

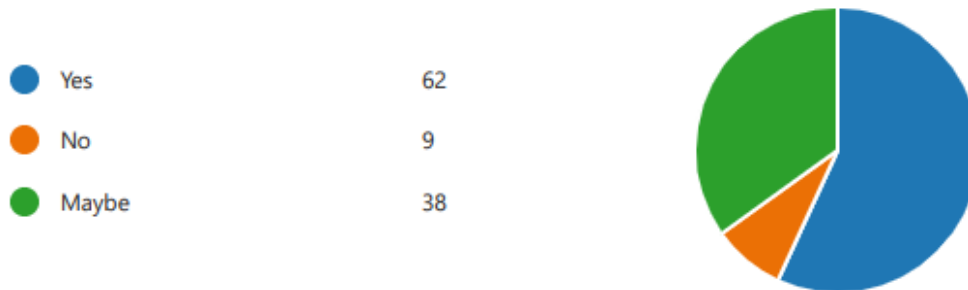
Overall, the product seems to perform well in terms of reliability, security, and performance, while there are areas for improvement in terms of integration with other software and cost.



4.6. Customers satisfaction ratings

Customers' responses regarding their satisfaction with post-purchase service and ease of providing feedback vary, with some indicating satisfaction, some uncertainty, and others expressing dissatisfaction or inability to provide feedback easily.

Chart 4.7. Post-purchase customer satisfaction rating



The responses to the question about the likelihood of paying for a software upgrade demonstrate a spectrum of attitudes among customers. While some are very likely or somewhat likely to pay for an upgrade, others are somewhat unlikely or very unlikely to do so. Additionally, a notable portion of respondents indicated neutrality, expressing neither a strong inclination nor a strong aversion to paying for the upgrade. This suggests that customer willingness to pay for upgrades varies, likely influenced by factors such as perceived value, cost, and the perceived necessity of the upgrade. Further analysis could explore the reasons behind these varied attitudes and how they might inform pricing and marketing strategies for software upgrades.



Chart 4.8. If an upgrade for this software becomes available, how likely would you be to pay for it?

The responses indicate a generally positive outlook on continuing business with the Apple in the future, with many customers expressing a likelihood of doing so ranging from somewhat likely to extremely likely. This suggests a high level of satisfaction and loyalty among the customer base, which bodes well for future business retention and growth. However, there are also a few respondents who are less likely to continue doing business, indicating potential areas for improvement or areas where customer expectations may not have been met. Overall, the analysis suggests a positive sentiment towards future business interactions with the company.



Chart 4.9. How likely are you to continue doing business with us in the future?

The responses indicate a range of likelihoods in recommending the company to others, with ratings varying from 1 to 10. Most respondents gave high ratings, indicating a strong likelihood of recommending the company to friends or colleagues. However, there are a few lower ratings, suggesting that some customers may not be as inclined to recommend the company. Overall, the majority of respondents seem favorable towards recommending the company, indicating a positive perception of the brand among its customers.

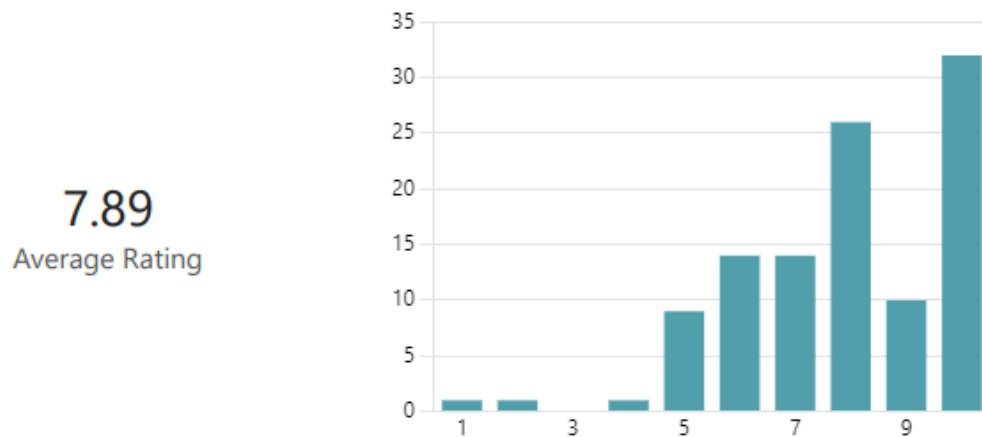


Chart 4.10. How likely are you to recommend our company to a friend or colleague?

The factors believed to have contributed to the growth of Apple as a brand include:

1. Strong brand reputation
2. High-quality products
3. Innovative product design
4. Effective marketing and advertising
5. Customer loyalty and advocacy
6. User-friendly interfaces and software

These factors were selected multiple times by respondents, highlighting their perceived importance in Apple's brand success.

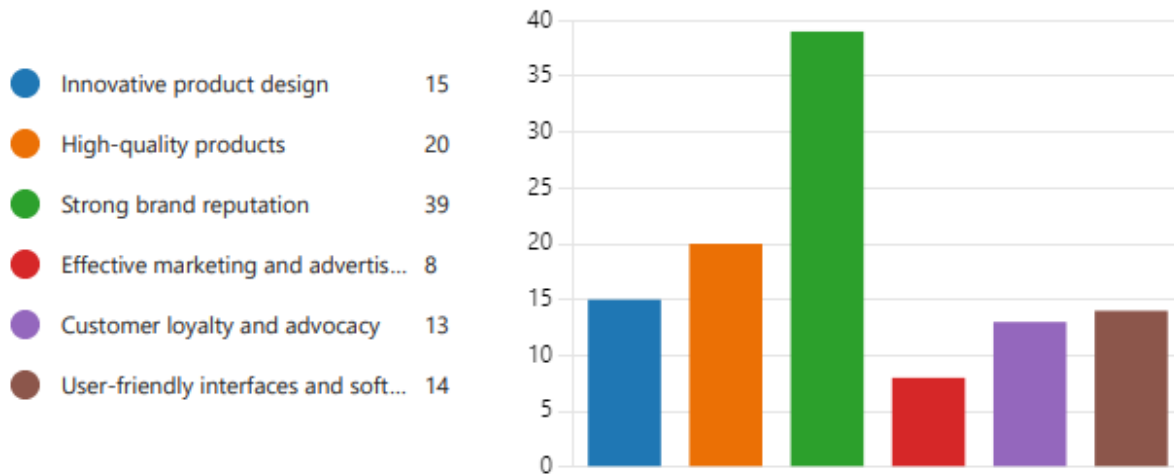


Chart 4.11. What factors do you believe have contributed to the growth of Apple as a brand?

The analysis indicates that respondents believe Apple excels in various aspects compared to its competitors, including:

1. Brand image and reputation
2. Product performance and reliability
3. Innovation and technology advancement
4. Product design and aesthetics
5. User experience and interface design
6. Customer service and support

These factors collectively contribute to Apple's perceived superiority over its competitors in the eyes of the respondents.

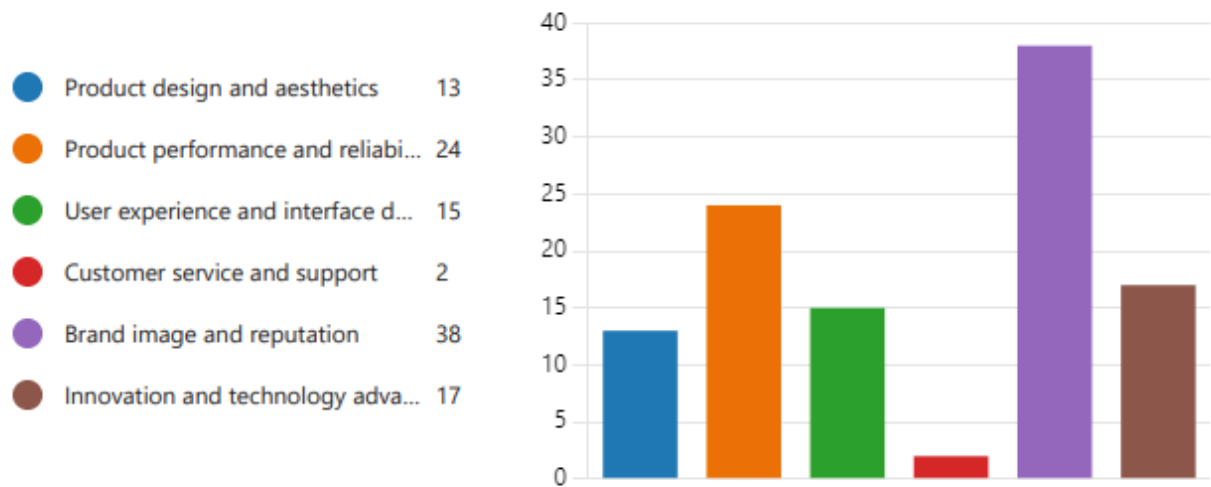


Chart 4.12. In your opinion, what does Apple as a brand do better than their competitors?

The analysis shows that factors such as brand loyalty and user experience play a significant role in the decision-making process for purchasing Apple products, with respondents indicating them as very influential in most cases. Some respondents also find these factors to be moderately influential, while a few consider them slightly influential or not influential at all. Overall, brand loyalty and user experience are key determinants in influencing consumers' decisions to buy Apple products.



Chart 4.13. How influential are factors like brand loyalty and user experience in your decision to purchase Apple products?

The analysis indicates that while some respondents have switched from using Apple products to products from other brands, the majority have not. Among those who have switched, the reasons vary, with some citing motivation such as dissatisfaction with Apple products, curiosity about other brands, or specific features offered by competitors. However, many respondents express loyalty to Apple by stating that they have not switched or are uncertain about doing so in the future.



Chart 4.14. Have you ever switched from using Apple products to products from other brands? If yes, what motivated this switch?

The analysis reveals the age distribution of the respondents, with the majority falling within the 26-35 age range. There are also significant numbers of respondents in the 18-25 and 36-45 age ranges, while a smaller proportion is above 45 years old.

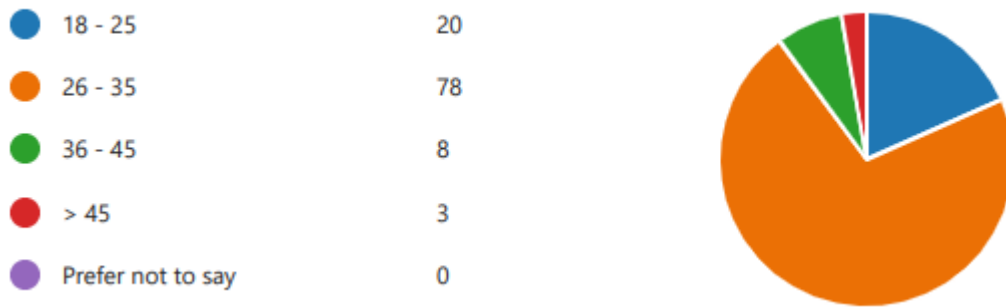


Chart 4.15. How old are you?

The analysis displays the locations of the respondents, indicating a diverse geographic spread. The most common locations mentioned include Nigeria, various cities in Ohio (such as Dayton, Fairborn, and Cincinnati), the United Kingdom (UK), Lagos, and Canada. Other locations mentioned include the United States (USA), Ireland, Scotland, New Jersey, New York, Houston, and Toronto. There are also some humorous or generic responses like "Earth" and "Dayton Ohio."

102
Responses

Latest Responses

"Nigeria"

"Cincinnati "

"Lagos "

17 respondents (17%) answered **Ohio** for this question.

Word cloud showing locations mentioned by respondents who answered **Ohio**:

- Ohio
- Lagos
- United States
- Fairborn
- United Kingdom
- Nigeria
- Canada
- London
- Orange
- Dayton Ohio
- Uk
- New Jersey
- County
- state
- abia

Chart 4.16. Where are you located?

The responses indicate a mix of gender identifications, with "Man" and "Woman" being the most common selections. There is also one respondent who preferred not to disclose their gender.

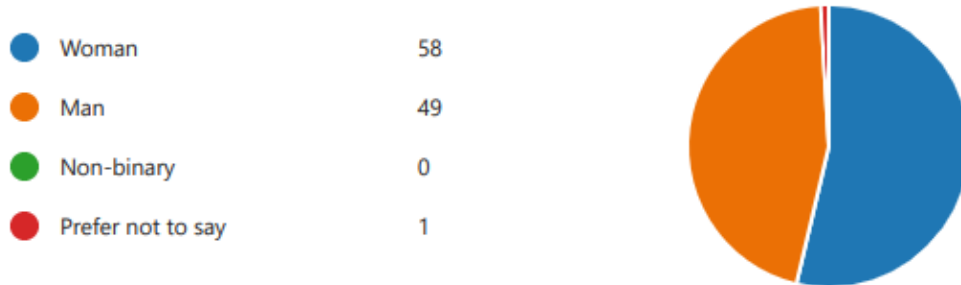


Chart 4.17. By what gender do you identify?

The responses show a diverse range of marital statuses, with "Single" being the most common choice. There are also respondents who indicated they are "Married," along with a few who preferred not to disclose their marital status.

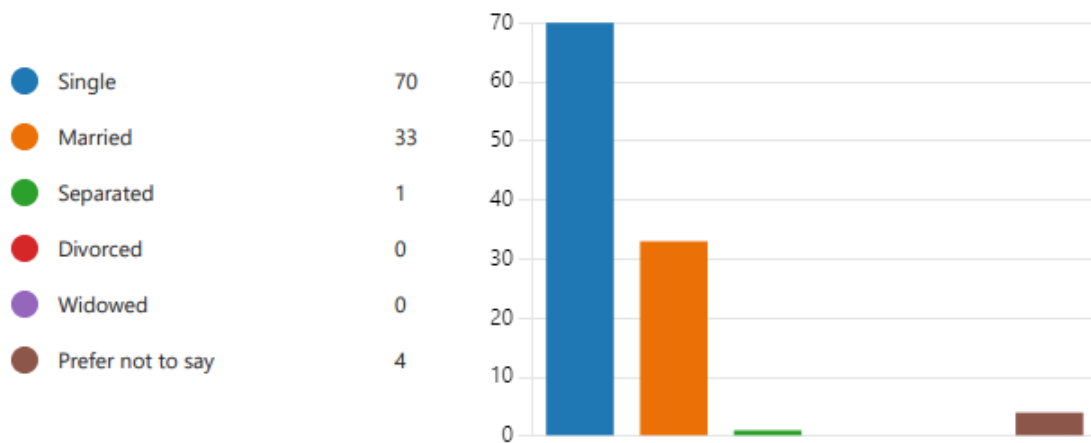


Chart 4.18. What is your marital status?

The responses reflect a varied educational background among participants, with a significant number holding Bachelor's degrees and Master's degrees. There are also individuals with Doctorate degrees, Associate's degrees, and some who mentioned completing high school.

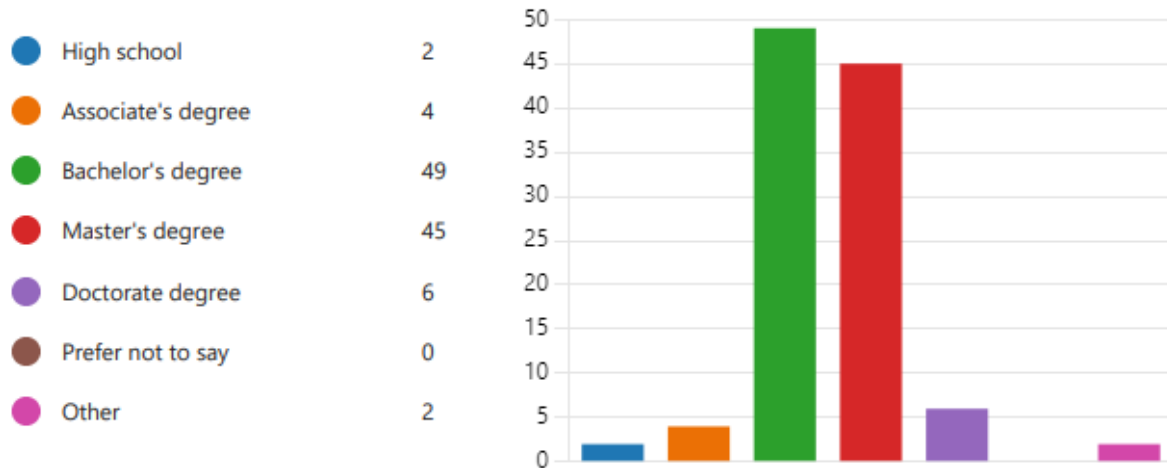


Chart 4.19. What is your level of education?

The respondents' job titles encompass a broad range of professions and roles, including research assistant, student, data engineer, entrepreneur, service engineer, business analyst, accountant, medical doctor, assistant vice president, quality specialist, senior cyber engineer, financial analyst, nurse aide, graduate student, teaching assistant, software engineer, customer success manager, network engineer, facilities administrator, rapper, self-employed individual, caregiver, HR admin, lawyer, executive assistant, banker, personal assistant, cloud solutions architect, marketing professional, TV host, CEO, product manager, digital marketing manager, civil servant, partner, worker, lead baker, art director/illustrator, IT consultant, case manager, licensed practical nurse, manager, AML analyst, solicitor, designer, supply chain consultant, HR professional, finance manager, security analyst, trainer, and CFO.

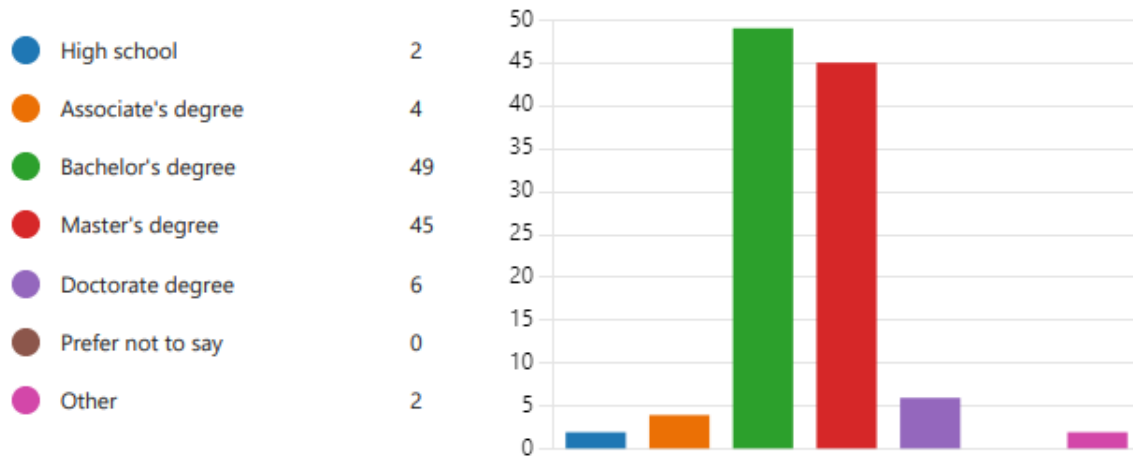


Chart 4.20. What is your job title?

4.2. Analysis and Presentation of Secondary Data

The revenue growth of the company can be analyzed by observing the change in revenue over the years. Here's a breakdown of the revenue growth. Further, from 2006 to 2009, there is a steady increase in revenue, with a notable jump from \$19.1 billion in 2006 to \$42.7 billion in 2009. This period represents a significant growth phase. On that same hand, the years 2010 to 2012 show substantial growth, with revenues more than doubling from \$65 billion in 2010 to \$156.3 billion in 2012. This period reflects a period of rapid expansion and increased market penetration. The years 2013 to 2015 continue to demonstrate robust growth, with revenues reaching \$233.6 billion in 2015. This period indicates sustained growth and continued success in the market. From 2016 to 2019, there is some fluctuation in revenue, with a peak of \$274.5 billion in 2020. Despite some variability, the overall trend is one of continued growth and resilience. The year 2021 stands out with a significant increase in revenue to \$365.8 billion, representing a substantial growth spurt. However, in 2022 and 2023, there is a slight decline in

revenue, with figures of \$394.1 billion and \$383.2 billion, respectively. This may indicate market saturation, increased competition, or other external factors impacting revenue generation.

Overall, the revenue growth pattern shows a consistent upward trajectory with periods of rapid expansion interspersed with some fluctuations. This growth underscores the company's ability to innovate, adapt to market changes, and maintain a strong position in its industry.

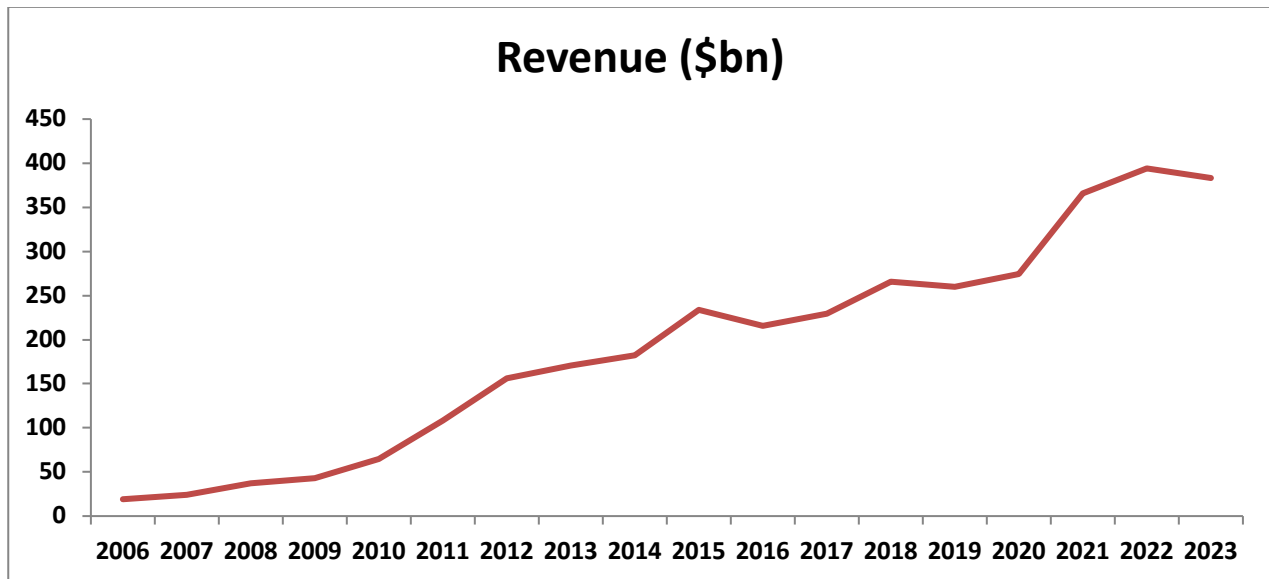


Chart 4.2.1. Trend analysis of revenue

CHAPTER FIVE

CONCLUSION OF FINDINGS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

5.0. Conclusion of Findings and Recommendations

5.1. Conclusion of findings

The discussion of analysis in chapter four above provides invaluable insights into various aspects of consumer behavior, satisfaction levels, and perceptions regarding Apple products. Therefore, the following key conclusions are drawn from the discussion above.

Customer Loyalty and Satisfaction: The majority of respondents have been using Apple products for an extended period, indicating high levels of satisfaction and loyalty among long-term users. This loyalty is reinforced by a significant number of respondents who have been using Apple products for over a decade, highlighting a well-established reputation for the brand.

Consideration of Alternatives: While many respondents have remained loyal to Apple, Samsung emerges as a significant competitor, suggesting the importance of understanding and addressing the strengths and weaknesses of competing products like Samsung. However, a notable portion of respondents did not consider any alternatives, indicating a strong brand preference and satisfaction with Apple products.

Product Usage Patterns: The data shows that a high number of respondents use Apple products daily, reflecting strong engagement and dependency on the products in their daily lives. However, there are also users who report non-usage or occasional usage patterns, indicating potential areas for improvement in attracting and retaining customers in the future.

Valued Product Features: The most valued product features identified by respondents include camera quality, phone functionality, security features, messaging tools, ecosystem integration, user interface, and overall user experience. These insights can inform product development and marketing strategies to meet user needs effectively.

Challenges Encountered: Respondents reported various challenges while using Apple products, including battery life issues, performance issues, compatibility concerns, storage limitations, software-related challenges, and pricing concerns. Addressing these challenges effectively is crucial for enhancing overall user satisfaction in the future.

Future Business Interactions: Despite some challenges, respondents express a generally positive outlook on continuing business with Apple in the future. However, there are areas for improvement, as indicated by some respondents who are less likely to continue doing business or recommending the company to others in the future.

Factors Contributing to Brand Growth: Strong brand reputation, high-quality products, innovative design, effective marketing, customer loyalty, and user-friendly interfaces are perceived as key factors contributing to Apple's brand growth and superiority over its competitors in the market.

Influence of Brand Loyalty and User Experience: Brand loyalty and user experience are identified as highly influential factors in the decision-making process for purchasing Apple products by customers. This underscores the importance of maintaining strong brand reputation and delivering exceptional user experiences.

Customer Switching Behavior: While some respondents have switched from Apple products to competitors, the majority has not. Motivations for switching include dissatisfaction with Apple products, curiosity about other notable brands, or specific features offered by competitors that Apple does not offer.

In summary, the analysis provides valuable insights into consumer perceptions, preferences, and behaviors related to Apple products. Understanding these insights can help Apple identify areas for improvement, capitalize on strengths, and maintain its position as a leading brand in the market.

5.2. Recommendations

Based on the insights gathered from the conclusion above, therefore, here are the recommendations for Apple to considerations.

Strengthen Customer Loyalty: Apple should continue to focus on maintaining high levels of customer satisfaction and loyalty among its long-term users. This can be achieved by consistently delivering high-quality products, excellent customer service, and innovative features that meet or exceed user expectations.

Competitive Analysis: Understanding the strengths and weaknesses of competitors, particularly Samsung, is crucial for Apple's long-term success. Conducting regular competitive analyses can help Apple identify areas where it can differentiate itself and address any weaknesses in its product offering.

Enhance Product Usage Experience: While many users report daily usage of Apple products, there is a segment of users who report non-usage or occasional usage patterns. Apple should

investigate the reasons behind this and implement strategies to attract and retain these users, such as improving product affordability, expanding product offerings, or enhancing marketing efforts.

Focus on Valued Product Features: Apple should prioritize the development of features that are highly valued by customers, such as camera quality, phone functionality, security features, and user interface design. Investing in research and development to continuously improve these features can help Apple maintain its competitive edge in the market.

Address Customer Challenges: Apple should actively address the challenges reported by users, including battery life issues, performance issues, compatibility concerns, storage limitations, software-related challenges, and pricing concerns. Implementing software updates, providing efficient customer support, and offering flexible pricing options can help alleviate these challenges and improve overall user satisfaction.

Sustain Positive Outlook for Future Business: While most respondents express a positive outlook on continuing business with Apple, there are areas for improvement. Apple should focus on addressing the concerns of users who are less likely to continue doing business or recommending the company to others, ensuring that their needs and expectations are met.

Leverage Factors Contributing to Brand Growth: Apple should continue to leverage its strong brand reputation, high-quality products, innovative design, effective marketing, customer loyalty, and user-friendly interfaces to drive brand growth. Building on these strengths can help Apple maintain its position as a leader in the market.

Emphasize Brand Loyalty and User Experience: Brand loyalty and user experience are critical factors influencing consumers' decisions to purchase Apple products. Apple should prioritize initiatives that enhance brand loyalty, such as loyalty programs, exclusive offers, and

personalized customer experiences. Additionally, investing in user experience design and usability testing can help ensure that Apple products continue to provide exceptional user experiences.

Understand and Address Customer Switching Behavior: Apple should closely monitor customer switching behavior and understand the reasons behind it. By identifying common motivations for switching, such as dissatisfaction with products or curiosity about competitors, Apple can develop targeted strategies to retain existing customers and attract new ones.

On this note, implementing these recommendations by Apple will go along way to ensure more patronage from new customers, Therefore, Apple can continue to meet the evolving needs and preferences of its customers, drive brand growth, and maintain its position as a leading brand in the market.

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APPENDICE

Secondary Data

Year	Revenue (\$bn)
2006	19.1
2007	24.4
2008	37.4
2009	42.7
2010	65
2011	108
2012	156.3
2013	170.8
2014	182.6
2015	233.6
2016	215.4
2017	229.2
2018	265.5
2019	260.1
2020	274.5
2021	365.8
2022	394.1
2023	383.2

Primary Data

Have you ever swit	How old are you?	Where are you loca	By what gender do	What is your marita	What is your level c	What is your job titl
No	26 - 35	USA	Man	Married	Master's degree	
Maybe	18 - 25	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	Research Assistant
No	26 - 35	Dayton Ohio	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	Student
Yes	26 - 35	Orange County, CA	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Data Engineer
Yes	26 - 35	NIGERIA	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	ENTREPRENEUR
No	26 - 35	Indiana	Man	Single	Master's degree	Service Engineer
Yes	26 - 35	Lagos, Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	BA
No	26 - 35	Ohio	Man	Married	Master's degree	Accountant
No	26 - 35	Dayton, Ohio	Woman	Single	Doctorate degree	Medical Doctor
Yes	26 - 35	Birmingham	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	Entrepreneur
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Woman	Prefer not to say	Bachelor's degree	Student
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Man	Single	Associate's degree	
No	26 - 35	Dayton, Ohio	Man	Married	Doctorate degree	Assistant Vice President
No	26 - 35	Houston	Man	Married	Master's degree	Quality Specialist
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Entrepreneur
No	26 - 35	Ohio	Man	Married	Doctorate degree	Senior Cyber Engineer
No	26 - 35	Dayton	Man	Married	Master's degree	Financial Analyst
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Woman	Single	Associate's degree	Nurse aide
No	26 - 35	Ohio	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Graduate Student
Maybe	26 - 35	Ohio	Man	Single	Master's degree	Student
No	26 - 35	Ohio	Man	Married	Master's degree	Teaching assistant
No	36 - 45	Durham	Prefer not to say	Prefer not to say	Master's degree	Software engineer
No	26 - 35	Canada	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	
Yes	26 - 35	America	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Financial analysts
No	26 - 35	Lagos, Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Customer success man
Yes	> 45	Aba abia state	Woman	Married	High school	Accounting
Yes	26 - 35	IMO	Man	Married	Bachelor's degree	Banker
No	18 - 25		Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	Retail Operations Spec
Maybe	36 - 45	Uk	Man	Married	Master's degree	Network engineer
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	Customer support
Yes	26 - 35	United Kingdom	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Facilities Administrator
No	26 - 35	UK	Woman	Single	Doctorate degree	Student
No	26 - 35	Canada	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Business analyst
Maybe	18 - 25	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	Rapper
No	26 - 35		Woman	Single	Master's degree	
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	Data analyst
Yes	18 - 25	Earth	Man	Single	Master's degree	
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Self employed
Maybe	> 45	Lagos, Nigeria	Man	Married	Other diplomas too	Care giver
No	26 - 35	London	Woman	Married	Master's degree	HR Admin
No	18 - 25	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Undergraduate	Student
No	26 - 35	United States	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Lawyer
No	18 - 25	Lagos, nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	An Executive Assistant
No	18 - 25	London	Man	Single	Master's degree	Hrbp
No	26 - 35					
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	Banker
No	26 - 35	Uk	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Personal assistant
No	26 - 35	Lagos	Man	Married	Bachelor's degree	Data Engineer
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Software developer
No	26 - 35	Canada	Man	Married	Bachelor's degree	Cloud Solutions Archite
No	26 - 35	United Kingdom	Woman	Married	Master's degree	Data analyst
No	18 - 25	Lagos, Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Personal Assistant
Yes	36 - 45	Nigeria	Man	Married	Bachelor's degree	
Yes	18 - 25	United Kingdom	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Marketing
Yes	36 - 45	Lekki	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	Tv host
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Single	Master's degree	CEO
No	26 - 35		Man	Single	Master's degree	
Maybe	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Prefer not to say	Master's degree	Product manager
Yes	18 - 25	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Digital Marketing Man
Yes	36 - 45	Lagos Nigeria	Woman	Married	Master's degree	Civil servant
No	26 - 35	Lagos nigeria	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	
No	26 - 35		Man	Single	Master's degree	
No	18 - 25	Ohio, United States.	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Student
Yes	> 45	Lagos, Nigeria	Man	Married	Bachelor's degree	Partner
No	26 - 35	Ireland	Man	Single	Master's degree	Worker
Maybe	26 - 35	Lagos, Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Entrepreneur
Yes	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	
No	26 - 35		Man	Married	Master's degree	Engineer
Yes	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Lead baker
Yes	18 - 25	Nigeria	Man	Single	Associate's degree	Art Director/Illustrator
No	26 - 35	London	Woman	Single	Master's degree	IT Consultant
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Man	Single	Bachelor's degree	
Yes	26 - 35		Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	
Yes	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Lawyer
No	18 - 25	USA	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Student
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Woman	Separated	Bachelor's degree	Case Manager
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Woman	Single	Associate's degree	Licensed practical nurs
No	26 - 35	Dublin	Man	Single	Master's degree	
No	26 - 35	Dayton ohio	Man	Single	Doctorate degree	
Maybe	26 - 35	US	Man	Single	Master's degree	NA
Maybe	26 - 35	New Jersey	Man	Married	Master's degree	
No	26 - 35	U.S.A	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Manager
No	26 - 35	New York	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Lawyer
No	26 - 35	Scotland	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	
Yes	36 - 45	United Kingdom	Man	Married	Master's degree	AML Analyst
No	26 - 35	United Kingdom	Woman	Single	Bachelor's degree	Solicitor
Yes	26 - 35	Dayton, OH	Woman	Single	Doctorate degree	Student
No	26 - 35	UK	Man	Married	Master's degree	Designer
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Married	Bachelor's degree	Supply chain consultan
No	26 - 35	Toronto	Woman	Single	Master's degree	HR
No	18 - 25	Ohio	Woman	Single	High school	Caregiver
No	26 - 35	Fairborn, ohio	Woman	Single	Master's degree	
No	26 - 35	Nigeria	Woman	Single	Master's degree	Finance manager

How long have you	What alternatives	How often do you u	Which product feat	What challenges ha	Does our product h	Reliability	Ease of use	Visual appeal
2 - 5 years	Samsung, Google Pixel	Daily	iPhone		Yes	Extremely satisfied	Neutral	Neutral
6 - 12 months	Samsung	Daily	Camera	Battery Life	Yes	Neutral	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	I was first introduced t	Daily	iPhone	Sometimes it get slow	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Android	Daily	Phone	Device heating up	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
< 6 months	SAMSUNG	Daily	ALEXA	SWIFT RESPONSES	Yes	Dissatisfied		
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Phone	Low battery life	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	No alternative	Daily	Face ID	The 2017 MacBook Pro	Yes	Neutral	Satisfied	Satisfied
> 10 years	None	Daily	iMessage	Not very diverse in fur	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Durability and function	Daily	iMessage	Incompatibility with sc	Yes	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
5 - 10 years	Battery life	Daily	Camera quality, space	Camera quality, space, Maybe		Dissatisfied	Neutral	Neutral
2 - 5 years	Quality	Daily	Face ID feature on the	Charging system	Yes	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
2 - 5 years	None	Daily	Internet connectivity	Battery life doesn't las	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Camera quality	Memory limit	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Apple Pay	None	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	None	Daily	Camera		Yes	Neutral	Satisfied	Satisfied
1 - 2 years	Pixel	Daily	Facetime	Not as innovative as th	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Easy user interface	Manual connectivity t	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Nothing	Daily	AirPods	None	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	iCloud	None	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Nokia	Daily	iMsg	End user complexity	Yes	Satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied
< 6 months	Samsung	Daily	Camera	Paying for most of the	Maybe	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
> 10 years	NA	Daily	iPhone	NA	Maybe	Neutral	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	iCloud	None	Yes	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Camera	The phone hangs some	Yes	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
> 10 years	Android- HTC	Daily	Reminders	Overheating	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied
< 6 months	None	Weekly	All	Network failure	Maybe	Extremely dissatisfied	Dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
1 - 2 years	None	Daily	Photo gallery	Shortage of battery life	Yes	Neutral	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	FaceTime	Battery issues	Maybe	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
1 - 2 years	Tecno	Daily		It's close source can'	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
	HP	Never	None	Usability	No		Extremely dissatisfied	
5 - 10 years	Sony	Daily	Activity app	Battery health	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
6 - 12 months	Samsung, Google	Daily	User friendly	Downloading music	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Music	Frequent updates	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Face ID	iOS update	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Android	Daily	UI	Close-source code	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Sony	Daily	Phone		Maybe		Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Google pixel	Daily	Rear cameras	None	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
1 - 2 years	Samsung	Daily	Mobile Device	Broke Student	No	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	Photography	Easily syncing it with o	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	I did not consider any	Daily	The iPhone	My phone gets hot eas	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	User's friendly	Non for now	Yes			
5 - 10 years	Nil	Daily	Iphone	Upgrade	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
6 - 12 months		Daily	Product performance	None	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	Notes, Photos, Camera	None	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Price, ease of use	Yearly	Photography	None	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
> 10 years	No alternatives	Daily	Notes	Storage	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Apple Watch health tr	Siri speech recognition	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
6 - 12 months	Nil	Daily	All	Non	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Social media apps	Battery life	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
1 - 2 years	Samsung	Daily	Notification system	Nil	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
6 - 12 months	Samsung, HP, Dell	Daily	copying and pasting be	Some popular applicat	Yes	Satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	User Experience and S	Navigation on Mac	Yes	Satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	The camera	Storage	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years		Daily		iOS	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
1 - 2 years	Motorola	Daily		Short bat life	Maybe	Dissatisfied	Dissatisfied	Neutral
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	Camera	None	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	WhatsApp	Forgetting to turn on s	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	iCloud	Bugs	Yes	Dissatisfied	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Android Phones and V	Daily		None	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
> 10 years	Sony	Daily	The ecosystem	MacBooks are quite rig	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Neutral
5 - 10 years	Android	Daily			Yes	Neutral	Neutral	Neutral
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Safari	Sometimes the phone	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Camera	Non	Yes	Neutral	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
5 - 10 years		Daily			Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	The features.	Daily	The product design.	Battery health.	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Seasonal	Apple Store	Finding charger when	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
> 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Iphone	None	Yes	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
> 10 years	Samsung	Daily		Storage	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
> 10 years	Tecno	Daily	User interface	Battery	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Windows Hp laptop	Daily	Screenshot video recording		Yes			
1 - 2 years	Oppo, Samsung	Seasonal		Running out of Storage	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
< 6 months		Never			No	Neutral	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
> 10 years	Android	Daily	Communication	Too many update and	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years		Daily		Battery drains quickly	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years		Daily			Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Airdrop	The airdrop isn't effici	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Macbook	It doesn't work well w	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	App Store	None	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	N/a	Daily	N/a	N/a	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	Iphone	Price	Yes	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
5 - 10 years	Lenovo and Samsung	Daily	Apple	Issues with paying for	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Camera	Auto Pay for Applicati	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung	Daily	Phone	Non open access	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Samsung and Google F	Daily	iPhone	Technicality	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Neutral	Satisfied
> 10 years	None	Daily	None	None	Maybe	Satisfied	Satisfied	Neutral
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	My iPhone, AirPods Pr	None whatsoever	Yes	Neutral	Satisfied	Satisfied
2 - 5 years	Android and Microsoft	Daily		Regular everyday chall	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied
> 10 years	None	Daily	The technology	None	Yes	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied	Extremely dissatisfied
> 10 years	Android	Daily	Similar interface across	Inadequate storage	Yes	Satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Samsung	Daily	iPhone 15 pro	Slow response	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
2 - 5 years	Security	Daily	iMessage	Ease of sharing files/ d	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Satisfied
5 - 10 years	None	Daily	My phone	Battery life sometime	Yes	Satisfied	Satisfied	Neutral
2 - 5 years		Daily			Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
6 - 12 months	Samsung	Daily	Camera. Fast ios	Navigation. It's very di	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Neutral	Extremely satisfied
> 10 years	Blackberry or Android	Daily	The different Apps	Using my Naira card to	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied
5 - 10 years	Black Berry	Daily	Messaging	Not much	Yes	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied	Extremely satisfied

ID	Start time	Completion time	Email	Name	Last modified time
1	3/25/24 13:32:17	3/25/24 13:41:52	anonymous		
2	3/25/24 13:42:32	3/25/24 13:48:22	anonymous		
3	3/25/24 13:56:02	3/25/24 13:59:49	anonymous		
4	3/25/24 14:19:08	3/25/24 14:22:01	anonymous		
5	3/25/24 14:15:11	3/25/24 14:25:01	anonymous		
6	3/25/24 14:23:21	3/25/24 14:26:55	anonymous		
7	3/25/24 14:20:18	3/25/24 14:27:47	anonymous		
8	3/25/24 13:33:21	3/25/24 14:28:32	anonymous		
9	3/25/24 14:23:20	3/25/24 14:28:49	anonymous		
10	3/25/24 14:29:24	3/25/24 14:34:27	anonymous		
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17	3/25/24 15:06:51	3/25/24 15:11:04	anonymous		
18	3/25/24 15:09:57	3/25/24 15:13:54	anonymous		
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25	3/25/24 18:54:27	3/25/24 19:02:08	anonymous		
26	3/25/24 19:12:33	3/25/24 19:18:14	anonymous		
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36	3/25/24 22:56:51	3/25/24 22:59:21	anonymous		
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42	3/26/24 9:27:08	3/26/24 9:31:33	anonymous		
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60	3/28/24 8:57:48	3/28/24 9:02:29	anonymous		
61	3/28/24 10:27:35	3/28/24 10:31:48	anonymous		
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74	3/31/24 14:21:10	3/31/24 14:25:01	anonymous		
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78	3/31/24 14:46:20	3/31/24 14:53:26	anonymous		
79	3/31/24 15:04:43	3/31/24 15:08:10	anonymous		
80	3/31/24 15:15:32	3/31/24 15:17:56	anonymous		
81	3/31/24 17:07:59	3/31/24 17:19:49	anonymous		
82	3/31/24 17:49:31	3/31/24 17:53:55	anonymous		
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84	3/31/24 23:02:11	3/31/24 23:08:06	anonymous		
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93	4/3/24 17:35:16	4/3/24 17:38:37	anonymous		
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